

## Parks Board Meeting, May 20, 2026

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZAmfz06k3Jo">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZAmfz06k3Jo</a> |
| Publication Date | 2026-05-20T11:03:43Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## Municipal Meeting Report: Parks and Recreation Board

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order).

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Parks and Recreation Board was called to order by the presiding officer to conduct regular board business, address old and new park operations, and hear public comments.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present Board/Staff Members:** Taylor (Prairie Creek / staff presenter), Shannon (staff presenter), and presiding board members.
  - **Absent:** Carl and Mark (noted as absent during discussions).

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not explicitly noted in the transcript.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly addressed during the opening proceedings.
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#### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:04:41 Contract Review: Sports Programming and Teen Internship Agreement**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by board leadership.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a contract between the City of Muncie and the Boys and Girls Club of Muncie covering sports programming and the summer teen internship program. Board members noted that the agreement required final approval from the Board of Works.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote as presented, pending approval from the Board of Works.
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#### 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:13:17 Chris**
  - Appreciated the board recording the meeting.
  - Raised concerns regarding the ongoing State Board of Accounts investigation, urging the board and city council not to forget about past accountability issues or handle them improperly.
  - Expressed concern that Taylor should not be made a scapegoat for administrative issues at Prairie Creek Reservoir.
  - Criticized the use of sign-in sheets requiring addresses, stating it creates a chilling effect on public participation under Indiana law.
- **00:16:19 Doug Johnson**
  - Expressed frustration that Prairie Creek boat docks were still not installed as of May 20th, despite seasonal contract obligations running through October 31st.
  - Suggested that the board review contracts to offer pro-rated refunds or extensions for the lost 25 days of dock use.
  - Offered assistance from public servants skilled in diving to help with lake maintenance.
- **00:19:30 Kevin**
  - Echoed concerns regarding the delayed installation of Prairie Creek docks.
  - Supported the idea of pro-rated fees, credits toward next year's dock rentals, or other compensation for the late start of the boating season.
- **00:21:02 Ralph Craig**
  - Retired city police officer (and former Prairie Creek overseer 46 years ago).
  - Complained that the boat launching docks are unstable ("bounce" and throw people off), lack safety grab poles, and feature insufficient trash cans in the boating area.

- Argued that the \$30 boat launch fee is too high, particularly for senior citizens on fixed incomes, and requested a reduced rate (suggesting \$15 for seniors/certain watercraft).
  - **00:23:31 Unidentified Resident (Boat Owner)**
    - Shared a personal safety incident where a ski boat wake threw him back into his boat while tied to a narrow plastic launch dock.
    - Emphasized the need for wider, sturdier 4-foot docks and secure metal guide rods for tying off watercraft safely.
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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
    - **Prairie Creek Operations:** Staff reported that seasonal maintenance hiring is complete, security is staffed (John Evans), boat house bathrooms are functional following a closed-valve fix, and health department/water testing is ongoing.
    - **Tuhey Pool:** Opening is delayed due to ongoing staffing and management recruitment, despite mechanical updates being completed by the Sanitary District and Board of Works.
    - **Grant Updates:** Shannon announced receipt of a \$30,000 Ball Brothers Foundation grant for recreation programming and a \$2,500 Enterprise Rent-A-Car Foundation grant for the summer teen internship program.
    - **Budget Review:** The board scheduled a mid-year budget review and update for the July agenda in coordination with the city controller.
  - **Adjournment:** The meeting was **Approved by Voice Vote** to adjourn.
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